

Neeraja Thyagarajan

DIRECTOR QUALITY ENGINEERING

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Quality Engineering transformation leader with extensive experience leading quality strategy, test automation modernization, AI-enabled engineering, release governance, and productivity transformation for large-scale enterprise software. Proven record of building scalable automation capabilities, improving engineering efficiency and quality, and sustaining delivery through organizational and technology change. Experienced in building high-performing, distributed Quality Engineering organizations and partnering with engineering, product, release, and operations leaders.

LEADERSHIP IMPACT

- Lead a distributed Quality Engineering organization of approximately 30 professionals across India, Mexico, and the United States, including 3 managers, 2 architects, and 4 leads.
- Own the Quality Engineering roadmap and quality KPIs and targets for Oracle Fusion ERP across Project Portfolio Management, Grants Management, and Budgetary Control.
- Lead end-to-end Quality Engineering spanning functional and manual testing, UI automation, REST/API and integration testing, security, accessibility, test-data management, defect prevention, production-quality and customer escalations, and quality metrics.
- Led the transformation from legacy automation to a Selenium-based automation platform, using conversion utilities, standardized frameworks, and engineering practices to accelerate modernization while sustaining release-certification and maintenance commitments.
- Established an AI-assisted test automation generation capability that reduced automation authoring effort by 95%, while retaining human-in-the-loop review for engineering oversight and quality control.
- Improved team productivity by 75% through continuous enhancement of Quality Engineering processes, tooling, and AI-enabled capabilities; consistently maintained environment-related test-result noise below 5%.
- Sustained and increased automation-certification delivery during a significant capacity constraint by setting clear priorities, optimizing work allocation, strengthening operating discipline, and enabling the team through process, tooling, and AI-driven productivity improvements.
- Govern daily execution of approximately 4,000 automated tests across three concurrent releases, supporting approximately 15 formal quality-certification activities each day.
- Strengthened defect prevention through coverage at the originating layer and quality gates, enabling early regression identification and helping prevent release delays and production incidents.
- Built the current Quality Engineering organization from the ground up; hired approximately 100–150 professionals and developed approximately 15 managers and 20 architects through coaching, stretch assignments, and succession planning.

QUALITY ENGINEERING TECHNOLOGIES

Selenium • OATS • QTP • WinRunner • REST/API Test Automation • QC/ALM • Jira • Git • SQL • Oracle APEX • Oracle Forms • OAF • ADF • Spectra

GENERATIVE AI AND AGENTIC AI SYSTEM TESTING

- Led the team in defining the quality and testing strategy for Generative AI and Agentic AI capabilities encompassing all phases of SDLC.
 - Design: Partnered with Product Management to establish processes for identifying both deterministic and non-deterministic evaluation metrics for the requirement, defining measurable acceptance thresholds, and assessing system behavior against those thresholds.
 - Development: Worked with development teams in establishing unit testing process for LLM model comparison with respect to cost and performance and economic regression testing as part of CI/CD.
 - Testing: Guided enhancements to the unified test automation framework to support automated testing of Generative AI and Agentic AI use cases, including evaluation of functional behaviour, output quality, and reliability. Established guidelines for metric evals using LLMAJ and deterministic methods as part of end-to-end automation testing.

AI-ASSISTED SOFTWARE TESTING

- Hands-on experience using Codex and Cline in Visual Studio Code to improve test planning, derive test scenarios from functional requirements, develop test automation, plan test execution, triage failures, analyze code, and increase engineering productivity.
- Apply human-in-the-loop review to validate AI-generated outputs against functional requirements, engineering standards, test intent, and maintainability expectations.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Oracle India | July 2001–Present

Director, Quality Engineering, Fusion ERP

February 2022–Present

Lead Quality Engineering and test automation for Oracle Fusion ERP, accountable for quality strategy, automation modernization, release readiness, engineering productivity, organizational capability, and quality governance.

- Set the Quality Engineering strategy and operating model across Project Portfolio Management, Grants Management, and Budgetary Control.
- Own the Quality Engineering roadmap, quality KPIs, and targets; recommend annual workforce plans, enterprise quality standards, and quality-process changes to the engineering and product leadership group.
- Advise engineering and product leadership on release readiness, quality risk acceptance, and go/no-go recommendations using testing evidence collected across release sprints.
- Recommend quality-investment priorities and QA staffing needs for upcoming releases, aligning quality capacity with product risk and delivery commitments.
- Direct modernization of legacy automation to a Selenium-based platform, including standardized frameworks, conversion utilities, reusable libraries, validation practices, self-healing capabilities, and Selenium Grid compatibility.
- Lead AI-enabled Quality Engineering adoption, including AI-assisted test automation generation, adoption governance, estimation models, support channels, escalation mechanisms, reusable-code stewardship, and outcome tracking.
- Direct Agile and sprint-level quality planning, shift-left testing, CI/CD quality gates, automated validation, risk-based testing, quality metrics, and release retrospectives.
- Serve as reviewer and adviser on testability standards, developer-owned quality, code-review practices, defect triage, root-cause analysis, and defect-prevention actions.
- Ensure automation coverage across technology stacks and integration points with CRM, Supply Chain Management, and Human Capital Management to identify cross-product regressions affecting ERP functionality.
- Own hiring, performance management, workforce planning, mentoring, and succession-oriented development; mentor extended teams and professionals participating in Oracle's mentoring program across geographic regions.

ORACLE CAREER PROGRESSION

Group Manager, Quality Assurance | 2015–2022

Senior Manager, QA Automation | 2008–2015

Manager, QA Automation | 2005–2008

Project Lead, QA Automation | 2001–2005

Earlier Oracle contributions include standardizing testware authoring, improving automation infrastructure, rebuilding the framework during the transition to QTP, expanding automation into backend, API, end-to-end, and technology-integration testing, and building a WinRunner automation framework for Oracle Forms and OAF.

Xoriant Solutions | November 2000–June 2001

Senior Systems Analyst

- Worked in database administration and Java development.

Madras Fertilizers Ltd | July 1993–October 2000

Systems Analyst

- Developed and implemented MIS solutions supporting marketing and supply-chain functions.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATION

Master of Computer Applications | National Institute of Technology, Trichy | 1990–1993

Bachelor of Arts — Mathematics, Economics and Statistics | Sri Venkateswara University, Tirupati | 1987–1990

University First Rank | EXIN DevOps Master